

# Jungle Adventure Design Report

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# Top-Level Design Description

Jungle Adventure is a branching narrative game where the player listens to a story and then picks between 2 different options to progress the story. The goal is to get a good ending by helping characters in the story.

## Design Pillars

The below design pillars identify the types of fun which are key to the user experience

- Immersion
- Intellectual Problem Solving
- Discovery

| Immersion                                                                                        | Expression                                                                                                  | Discovery                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Players are pulled into a story world, imagining themselves as the protagonist making decisions. | Every choice is really an expression of what kind of adventurer the player wants to be (bold, curious etc.) | Players can explore different branches in the story. They may be left wondering what would have happened if they'd chosen differently. This will bring an element of replayability as some players will want to try again to get a different ending. |

## Audience & Marketing

Jungle Adventure is a single player branching narrative game designed to be played online via the Yoto Player which is a screen-free audio device recommended for children aged 3-12. This game aimed at kids aged 6-9 as the stories have been designed around that demographic. The screen-free, audio-only format suits this audience well

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as it encourages active listening and independent play without screen time concerns, which also appeals to the secondary audience of parents who are the actual purchasers of Yoto content.

## Core Gameplay

When the card is inserted into the Yoto player one of three stories is picked at random from the server. The story is streamed back to the player in real time. A few sentences of the story will be read out and then what options the player has. The player can then choose the left knob or the right knob depending on how they want to progress the story.

After the player chooses a button, the story continues, and the player will be given another option shortly after. This will repeat until the story finishes.

## Controls

Press the left button: Select Option 1

Press the right button: Select Option 2

## Gameplay Balance & Pacing

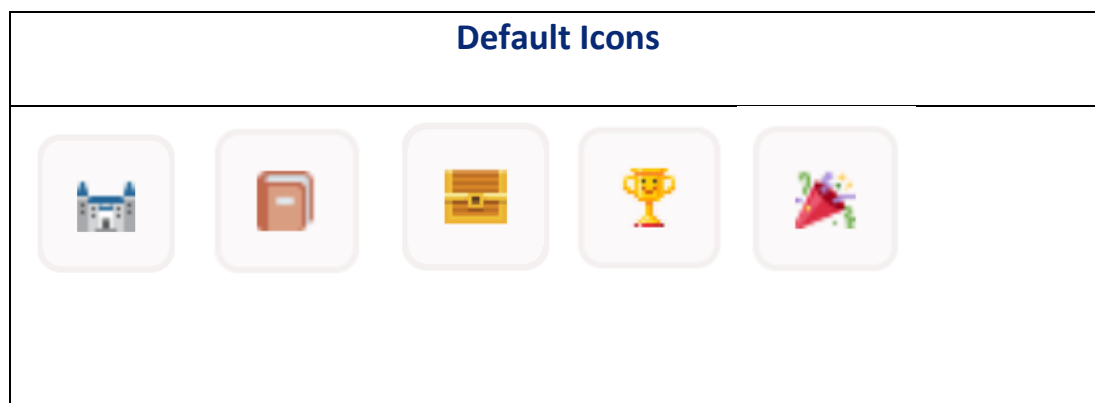
The game is a branching audio adventure, played through the Yoto Player with no screen. Each of the three stories has many decision points and branches. So the main balance challenge was making a wrong choice feel like a different path rather than a punishment. Since the game is fully audio-based and there's no visual feedback like a health bar or a game over screen to help visualize an outcome, every branch needed to lead somewhere worth hearing rather than a boring ending the story or just telling the player to start again.

## Tone & Aesthetics

Because Jungle Adventure is delivered through the Yoto Player, it is primarily an audio experience. Visual design is minimal, so the on-device icons are drawn from the default

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Yoto library but themed around exploration. The tone is light, encouraging, and age-appropriate for a branching narrative game.



## Narrative

All three stories share the same jungle setting but each story focuses on a different mystery: a lost baby elephant trying to find its herd, a thieving otter that turns out to be guarding something magical, and a missing firefly queen whose absence has plunged the jungle into total darkness. By keeping the location setting consistent across all three stories while varying the problems the protagonist comes across it makes the card feels like one cohesive world rather than three unrelated games on one card.

The player is always written in second person and present tense which keeps the narration immersive for an audio-only format when there's no visuals for the player. Every story opens with a short introduction of the setting and problem that sets the scene before the first real choice. This gives the player a moment to settle into the world before they make any decisions.

Each story has an animal companion that nudges the plot forward. This gives the player something to feel curious about. The ending of the story can be triumph, mishap, or surprise. Each type of ending is different. The triumph ending is proud and celebratory. The mishap ending is an invitation to try again, and the surprise ending has a sense of wonder.

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# Business Model

Jungle Adventure is a free-to-play Yoto game with no monetisation model. It will be made freely available to all users with no ads and no premium tiers.

The game is being developed as a portfolio project to demonstrate skills in game design and development. Its primary value is in the player experience and the learning gained through building it, rather than revenue generation.